Day 78 - Inland, Donna Baker, McKay's Harbour, Geodetic

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 102 · Lion's Head Provincial Nature Reserve

12.1 km / 7.5 mi	~4.4 h	2.4 km new	205 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive each way, Sat 7 am

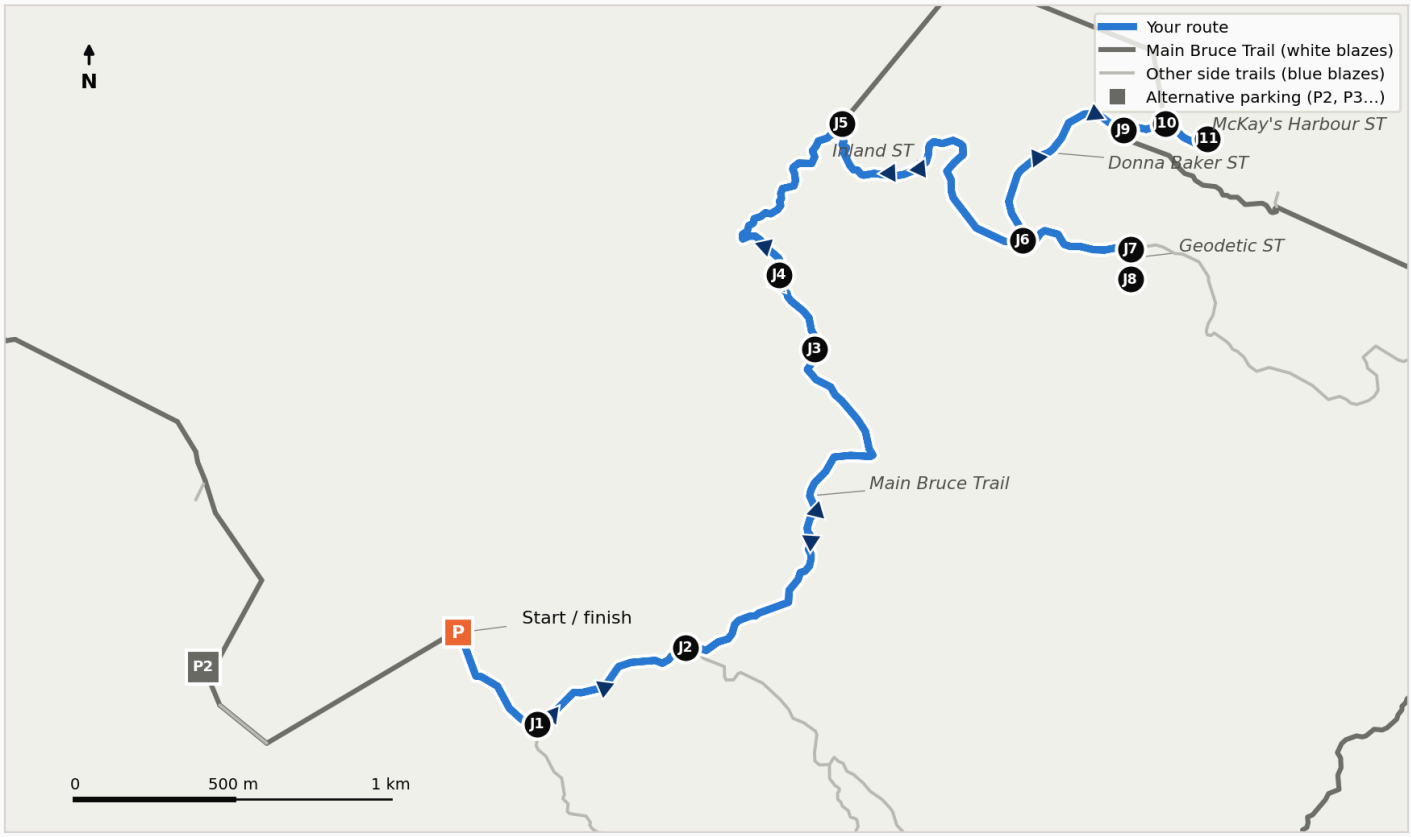
Park (P): McCurdy Drive Municipal Parking Lot (off of Moore St.): Online booking is required - visit lionsheadparking.ca. No RVs or trailers permitted. Do not block access or park on Moore St. Google Maps. **Paid: $20 for 4 hours or $30 full day · book ahead** · online booking (ParkPass via lionsheadparking.ca); Booking required May 15-Oct 15 (full day 24 h ahead); free shuttle from Arena lot ($15/day) summer weekends

Navigate: import *day78_hike102.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Inland Side Trail (1.5 km); Donna Baker Side Trail (0.7 km); McKay's Harbour Side Trail (0.2 km); Geodetic Side Trail (0.1 km)

Route map

Day 78 | 12.1 km (7.5 mi)



What to expect

- **Parking:** The McCurdy Drive lot is small. Book online at lionsheadparking.ca (required mid-May to October 15, at least 24 hours ahead; $20 for 4 hours or $30 a day). No RVs or trailers, and do not park on Moore St. In summer the municipality suggests the Lion's Head Arena lot and free shuttle.
- **Road walking:** The main trail starts and ends on the road shoulder through Lion's Head village. Keep Zappy close.
- **Main Bruce Trail & lookouts:** This is the popular Lion's Head lookout route: rocky, rugged ground, technical rock, and Georgian Bay views that get better as you go. The trail often runs very close to the cliff edge, so keep Zappy on a short leash. Expect crowds in summer.
- **Giant's Cauldron & Lion's Head Pothole:** Short spurs to glacial potholes, holes carved into the rock by glacial activity.
- **McKay's Harbour Side Trail:** A short spur toward McKay's Harbour, a cove with a backcountry campsite on the shore.
- **Inland & Donna Baker Side Trails:** Interior trails through woodland with wildflowers and karst landforms. No detailed terrain descriptions were found.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Lion's Head Harbour: The best parking is on Phillip Forbes St, right on the Trail by the beach map	Paid (amount not confirmed)	0.0	1070 m	

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: McCurdy Drive Municipal Parking Lot (off of Moore St.): Online booking is required -.... Head south-east on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
0.4	0.3	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Warder Side Trail goes off on your right.)
1.0	0.6	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail goes off on your right.)
2.5	1.5	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Giant's Cauldron Side Trail goes off on your right.)
2.7	1.7	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the blue-blazed Lion's Head Pothole Side Trail goes off on your right.)
3.5	2.2	J5: Turn sharp right onto the blue-blazed Inland Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
4.6	2.8	J6: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Inland Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Donna Baker Side Trail goes off on your left.)
5.0	3.1	J7: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Geodetic Side Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Inland Side Trail goes off ahead.)
5.1	3.2	J8: End of the Geodetic Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
5.2	3.2	J7: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Inland Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Inland Side Trail goes off on your right.)
5.6	3.5	J6: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Donna Baker Side Trail, heading north. (the Inland Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
6.2	3.9	J9: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
6.4	3.9	J10: Turn right onto the blue-blazed McKay's Harbour Side Trail, heading south-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
6.5	4.1	J11: End of the McKay's Harbour Side Trail. Turn around and retrace your steps.
6.7	4.2	J10: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
6.9	4.3	J9: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Donna Baker Side Trail, heading north-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
7.5	4.7	J6: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Inland Side Trail, heading west. (the Inland Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
8.6	5.3	J5: Turn sharp left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
9.4	5.8	J4: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Lion's Head Pothole Side Trail goes off on your left.)
9.7	6.0	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the blue-blazed Giant's Cauldron Side Trail goes off on your left.)
11.1	6.9	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Ilse Hanel Side Trail goes off behind you.)
11.7	7.3	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Warder Side Trail goes off on your left.)
12.0	7.4	Heads-up: The next 0.2 km follows a road shoulder; keep the dog close.
12.1	7.5	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail

descriptions draw on Northern Bruce Peninsula, 10Adventures, Fastest Known Time, the Ontario Parks trail map and the Great Lakes Sea Kayaking Association.